

Chat, Cowork, and Code in Microsoft Copilot

Microsoft Copilot offers different experiences for different kinds of work. In simple terms: **Chat helps you think and create**, **Cowork completes work on your behalf**, and **Code helps you build or modify software**.

Chat

Chat is the conversational experience for asking questions, brainstorming, drafting, summarizing, researching, and getting quick insights. It normally works within a single interactive session: you provide a prompt, review the response, and decide what to do next. Use Chat when you want a fast answer or content that you will review and apply yourself.

Cowork

Cowork is an agentic experience for delegating multi-step work across Microsoft 365. It can plan and carry out tasks such as creating documents, managing files, preparing briefings, sending email, posting in Teams, and scheduling meetings. You can follow its progress and review or approve sensitive actions. Use Cowork when you want an outcome completed across apps, files, or systems rather than just advice about how to complete it.

Code

Code is the software-development experience. It is designed for tasks such as explaining code, generating or refactoring code, diagnosing errors, creating tests, and working with repositories or development tools. Unlike general Chat, it uses coding-oriented context and workflows so that suggestions fit the codebase and development task. Use Code when the desired result is software or a change to software.

At a glance

Experience	Best for	Typical result
Chat	Questions, ideas, drafts, summaries, and quick research	An answer, insight, or content for you to use
Cowork	Delegated, multi-step work across Microsoft 365	A completed task or coordinated set of actions
Code	Software development and codebase changes	Code, tests, fixes, explanations, or implementation changes

